



Benevolent House ACADEMY

Where Foundations Become Futures

PLAN OF OPERATION

Form 2948

Where Foundations Become Futures

508 N State Hwy 342, Red Oak, TX 75154
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Licensed Child Care Center | Operation #1832672 | Revised October 2026

Head of Governing Body: Tanya Orr

Chief Operating Officer and Secondary Director: Christopher Orr

Primary Director: Haddie Mashburn

Assistant Director: Vanessa Wright

Executive Director: Tanya Orr

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APPLICANT INFORMATION

Operation Name: Benevolent House Academy

Location Address: 508 N State Hwy 342, Red Oak, TX 75154

Phone: (469) 807-1221

Email: info@benevolenthouseacademy.org

Operation Type: Licensed Child Care Center

Licensed Capacity: 52 children

Age Range: 6 weeks through 13 years (licensed). Current program: 6 weeks through 5 years.

Hours of Operation: Monday through Friday, 6:00 AM to 6:00 PM. The center is licensed for 24-hour care; weekend and evening care will be added in phases (see Services). The center is closed on the following 16 days each year, including two staff in-service days: New Year's Day, Martin Luther King Jr. Day, Presidents' Day (staff in-service day), Good Friday, Memorial Day, Juneteenth, Independence Day (July 4th), Labor Day, the second Monday in October (staff in-service day), the Wednesday before Thanksgiving, Thanksgiving Day, the day after Thanksgiving, December 23, Christmas Eve, Christmas Day, and New Year's Eve.

Services: Full-time infant, toddler, and preschool care for children 6 weeks through 5 years in five age-based classrooms, with breakfast, lunch, and afternoon snack through the Child and Adult Care Food Program (CACFP). Planned programs (licensed, not yet offered): weekend daytime care for ages 2 through 13, evening care for ages 2 and older, and a school-age summer program with field trips. The center does not currently provide transportation.

SECTION I: PERMIT HOLDER RESPONSIBILITIES

1. Who will be the person(s) responsible for ensuring that the Minimum Standard Rules are in compliance at all times?

The Primary Director, Haddie Mashburn, is responsible for ensuring daily on-site compliance with all minimum standards. The Assistant Director, Vanessa Wright, supports the Primary Director in daily operations and compliance. Christopher Orr, Chief Operating Officer and Secondary Director, supports both directors. The Governing Body Designee, Tanya Orr (Head of Governing Body), maintains oversight responsibility and ensures the operation has adequate resources, personnel, and policies to maintain compliance at all times.

2. If the director or primary caregiver is not present at the center, who will be in charge?

When the Primary Director, Haddie Mashburn, is absent from the center during operational hours, the Assistant Director, Vanessa Wright, serves as the designated person in charge. If both are absent, Christopher Orr, Chief Operating Officer and Secondary Director, serves as the designated person in charge. If all three are absent, Tanya Orr, Head of the Governing Body, designates a qualified caregiver to be in charge. The designated person in charge will be informed that they are in charge and the expected duration of the director's absence, will know their responsibilities while in charge, will have access to all necessary information to communicate with parents and state and local authorities, and will have the authority to manage the center in accordance with minimum standards per Section 746.1013. If the director will be absent for an extended period, a person who meets director qualifications is named temporary director and reported to Licensing as Section 746.1013 requires.

3. How do you plan to maintain these records in order for all of the information to be current?

Benevolent House Academy uses the Brightwheel childcare management platform to maintain digital records for all enrolled children. Children's admission information is reviewed and updated at least every 6 months; infant feeding instructions are reviewed and updated with the parent every 30 days until the infant is able to eat table food (Section 746.2421). Personnel records are reviewed at the time of hire and updated as certifications and training are completed. The director conducts a comprehensive records audit at least quarterly to verify all files are current and complete. An employee tracking spreadsheet is maintained to monitor hire dates, background check due dates, training hours completed, and certification expiration dates. All records are stored securely at the center and are available for review by licensing staff at any time.

4. What method(s) will you use to ensure that parents are informed?

Parents are informed through the Brightwheel app, which serves as the primary communication platform. Through Brightwheel, parents receive daily activity reports and photos, real-time notifications of illness or injury on the day of occurrence, messages about upcoming events and policy updates, and digital copies of incident reports. Additionally, operational policies are provided to each family at enrollment and updated copies are distributed whenever changes occur. Emergency notifications (such as communicable disease exposure, facility closures, or weather-related changes) are sent immediately through Brightwheel push notifications. A parent handbook outlining all policies is provided at enrollment and parents sign an acknowledgment of receipt.

5. How will you document sending this information to licensing and track when background checks are due?

Background checks are submitted through the HHSC online background check system upon hire for all employees and every 5 years thereafter. The director maintains a personnel tracking spreadsheet that includes each employee's name, date of hire, date of most recent background check, and the date the next background check is due. This spreadsheet is reviewed monthly by the director and quarterly by the Head of the Governing Body. Automated calendar reminders are set 90 days and 30 days prior to each employee's background check renewal date to ensure timely submission. Documentation of all background check submissions and results is maintained in each employee's personnel file.

6. How will new employees be oriented in the following topics?

All new employees complete a comprehensive orientation within 7 days of hire and before having unsupervised access to a child in care using the Benevolent House Academy New Employee Orientation Curriculum (see Appendix C). The orientation covers the following topics as specified on Form 2948:

Overview of Chapter 746 Minimum Standard Rules applicable to the employee's position and responsibilities. Overview of the operation's policies including discipline and guidance practices, procedures for the release of children, and daily operational procedures. Overview of the center's policy on the prevention, recognition, and reporting of child abuse and neglect, including: factors indicating a child is at risk of abuse or neglect, warning signs indicating a child may be a victim of abuse or neglect, procedures for reporting child abuse or neglect to DFPS, and community organizations that have training programs available to staff, children, and parents.

Overview of procedures for handling emergencies, which includes sharing the emergency preparedness plan with all employees. Emergencies covered include but are not limited to fire, explosion, tornado, toxic fumes, volatile persons, and severe injury or illness of a child or adult. Orientation also covers location and use of fire extinguishers and first-aid equipment, administering medication in compliance with 26 TAC Section 746.3803, preventing and responding to emergencies due to food or allergic reactions, understanding building and physical premises safety including identification and protection from hazards such as electric hazards, bodies of water, and vehicular traffic, handling, storing, and disposing of hazardous materials in compliance with 26 TAC Section 746.3425, and precautions for transporting children if the center transports a child whose chronological or developmental age is younger than nine years old.

Benevolent House Academy's orientation also includes trauma-informed care principles and social-emotional development practices (see Appendix C for the full curriculum). Caregivers who are not exempt under Section 746.1307 complete 24 clock hours of pre-service training covering the topics in Section 746.1305: 8 clock hours before being counted in the child-to-caregiver ratio, and the remaining 16 clock hours within 90 days of employment. Caregivers of children younger than 24 months receive one hour of pre-service training on shaken baby syndrome and abusive head trauma, safe sleep and SIDS prevention, and early childhood brain development. All caregivers and directors complete pediatric first aid with rescue breathing (before having unsupervised access to a child and within 90 days of employment) and pediatric CPR (within 90 days of employment), and keep both current. Orientation documentation is signed by the employee and maintained in their personnel file. A copy of the orientation curriculum is available at the center for review by the licensing representative.

All employees are issued Benevolent House Academy branded shirts during orientation and are required to wear BHA-branded shirts during all operating hours so that parents, visitors, and children can easily identify authorized staff members.

7. How will you ensure that your caregivers receive the required hours of training?

Each caregiver completes a minimum of 24 clock hours of annual training, and each director completes a minimum of 30 clock hours, within 12 months of employment and during each 12-month period after that (Section 746.1313). Annual training covers the areas required by Sections 746.1309 and 746.1311 and is separate from orientation, pre-service training, and pediatric first aid and CPR. At least 5 of a caregiver's annual hours are instructor-led, and no more than 3 hours are self-study. The director maintains a training tracking spreadsheet for each employee that documents training topic, date completed, number of hours, and training provider. Training hours are reviewed monthly by the director. Employees who are behind on training hours are notified in writing and a plan is developed to complete the required hours before their annual anniversary date. Training is obtained through a combination of in-house training sessions, online courses through approved providers, and community-based workshops.

8. Do you have a preservice training curriculum or will you only hire caregivers who already meet the requirement?

Benevolent House Academy maintains a preservice training curriculum on site AND also seeks to hire caregivers who already meet preservice training requirements whenever possible. The preservice training curriculum covers all topics required by minimum standards and is available at the center for review by the licensing representative. New hires who have not yet completed preservice training complete the first 8 clock hours before being counted in ratio and the remaining 16 clock hours within 90 days. Caregivers with at least two years of experience in a

regulated child-care center, or with documentation of 24 clock hours of pre-service training from another regulated center, are exempt under Section 746.1307.

SECTION II: OPERATION/PHYSICAL FACILITIES

1. Each child must have 30 square feet of indoor activity space. On your attached floor plan, indicate which age group and how many children will be in each room or area.

The attached floor plan identifies each classroom with the designated age group and capacity. Indoor activity space meets the minimum of 30 square feet per child as required by Section 746.4205. The following table summarizes the room assignments:

Room	Age Group	Capacity	Ratio	Staff
Seedlings (Classroom 0)	6 weeks - 11 months	4	1:4	1
Discoverers (Classroom 1)	12 - 17 months	5	1:5	1
Explorers (Classroom 2)	18 - 35 months	11 (no more than 9 under age 2)	1:9 if any child is under 2; 1:11 if all are 2	1 (2 when more than 9 children and any child is under 2)
Innovators (Classroom 3)	3 years	15	1:15	1
Scholars (Classroom 4)	4 - 5 years	17	1:18	1
Achievers (Classroom 5)	School-age, 5 - 13 years (when offered)	Within total capacity	1:22 (age 5); 1:26 (ages 6-13)	As needed
TOTAL		52		5-6

The Seedlings capacity is limited to 4 infants based on usable activity space after accounting for crib placement and required equipment. The permit allows a total infant capacity of 9 (4 in Seedlings plus 5 in Discoverers). The Achievers room is reserved for the school-age summer program when it is offered; enrollment in all rooms combined never exceeds the licensed capacity of 52. In mixed-age groups, BHA staffs by the youngest child in the group, which is stricter than the specified-age formula in Section 746.1603. Total building size is approximately 5,312 square feet. The Certificate of Occupancy allows a maximum of 59 persons. At full capacity: 52 children + 6 caregivers + 1 director = 59 persons.

2. List the equipment and materials you will have for each age group you plan to serve, including both indoor and outdoor equipment and materials.

A detailed equipment and materials list for each classroom and the outdoor play area is provided in Appendix D: Equipment and Materials Checklist. A summary for each age group is provided below:

Seedlings (6 weeks-11 months): Safety-approved cribs, infant swings and bouncer seats (used only while awake and supervised, never for sleep), tummy time mats, soft blocks, rattles, teething toys, mirrors, board books, and a diaper changing station with safety strap.

Discoverers (12-17 months): Push/pull toys, soft dolls, stacking cups, sensory bins, board books, play kitchen items, low climbing structures, musical instruments, large crayons, finger

paint, child-sized tables/chairs, individual cots, and a diaper changing station with safety strap near a handwashing sink.

Explorers (18-35 months): Large building blocks, pretend play items, puzzles, crayons, markers, playdough, sensory tables, picture books, dress-up clothing, musical instruments, art easels, and individual cots.

Innovators (3 years): Building blocks, puzzles, scissors/glue, painting supplies, dramatic play center, science exploration materials, books, alphabet/number manipulatives, writing materials, listening center, and individual cots.

Scholars (4-5 years): Writing center with journals, math manipulatives, science center, art center, reading nook, dramatic play center, construction area, phonics materials, educational tablet (supervised screen time), board games, and individual cots.

Achievers (school-age, when offered): Homework supplies, age-appropriate books, board/card games, sports equipment, arts/crafts supplies, science kits, building sets, educational tablet access, and cots/mats as needed.

Outdoor (all ages, staggered): Climbing structure with slide, ride-on toys, balls, outdoor art supplies, sports equipment, picnic tables, and open space for running and group games.

3. How many toilets will your operation have?

7 toilets total: 5 child-accessible toilets (one in each of Classrooms 1 through 5), 1 office restroom, and 1 staff restroom.

4. How many sinks will your operation have?

A minimum of 7 sinks: one handwashing sink in or near each restroom, plus a handwashing sink in the nursery for use during diapering. Handwashing sinks are equipped with soap and disposable towels.

5. How will children be supervised when they are using the restroom?

Children are supervised in the restroom in an age-appropriate manner that ensures both safety and privacy. Toddlers (12-23 months) are directly assisted by a caregiver during toileting and diapering. Two-year-olds are accompanied by a caregiver who provides hands-on assistance as needed. Three- and four-year-olds use the restroom with a caregiver stationed at the restroom door; the door remains open or ajar so the caregiver can hear and respond immediately while still providing reasonable privacy. When school-age care is offered, school-age children (5-13 years) use the restroom independently with caregiver awareness of their location and the duration of their absence from the group. At no time is a child left unsupervised in a restroom for an extended period. Caregivers assist all children with handwashing as needed after toileting.

SECTION III: ACTIVITIES AND CHILD CAREGIVER RATIO

1. What methods of discipline and guidance will you and your caregivers use when children misbehave?

Benevolent House Academy uses a trauma-informed, social-emotional approach to child guidance. Caregivers are trained to understand that behavior is communication, and to respond with empathy, connection, and consistency. Caregivers use the following guidance techniques: positive reinforcement and encouragement, emotion coaching (helping children name and regulate their feelings), redirection to appropriate activities, setting clear and consistent limits, offering age-appropriate choices, natural and logical consequences, modeling appropriate

behavior, co-regulation (a caregiver remaining calm and present to help a dysregulated child return to calm), and brief supervised separation from the group when necessary (not to exceed one minute per year of age).

The following methods are strictly prohibited and will result in immediate corrective action, up to and including termination: corporal punishment of any kind (spanking, hitting, slapping, pinching, shaking, biting, or any form of physical punishment), verbal abuse (threats, humiliation, profanity, shaming, or derogatory remarks), punishment associated with food, rest, or toileting, placing children in dark or locked rooms, requiring physical exercise as punishment, and any form of discipline that is frightening or humiliating to a child. These prohibitions are reviewed with all employees during orientation and annually thereafter.

Behavior Classification and Response

To ensure consistency and transparency, Benevolent House Academy classifies behaviors into three levels. The center's response is proportional to the severity and frequency of the behavior.

Level 1 Behaviors (Low-Level Concerns): These are developmentally typical behaviors that are addressed through routine guidance techniques. Examples include not following classroom rules, difficulty sharing or taking turns, minor verbal conflicts with peers, crying or whining, and refusing to participate in activities. Response: Caregivers use redirection, emotion coaching, and positive reinforcement. Parents are informed through daily reports if the behavior is persistent.

Level 2 Behaviors (Moderate Concerns): These are behaviors that are disruptive, persistent, or that may cause minor harm to the child, other children, or staff. Examples include biting, hitting, kicking, or pushing other children; throwing objects at others; persistent defiance or refusal to follow safety rules; destructive behavior toward classroom materials or property; and spitting at others. Response: The behavior is documented in an incident report. The parent is notified on the day of occurrence. If the behavior is recurring, the behavior escalation process is initiated.

Level 3 Behaviors (Serious Safety Concerns): These are behaviors that pose an immediate safety risk to the child, other children, or staff. Examples include severe physical aggression causing injury to another child or staff member, biting that breaks the skin, elopement (leaving the classroom or building without permission), self-injurious behavior, and threatening behavior toward staff or children. Response: The child is immediately separated from the group in a supervised area. The parent is contacted for immediate pickup. The behavior escalation process is initiated at the appropriate step based on severity.

Suspension and Expulsion

Benevolent House Academy is committed to working with families before considering suspension or disenrollment. If a child's behavior is a concern, the following process will be followed:

- **Step 1: Parent Conference.** The Director and caregiver will meet with the parent to discuss the behavior, identify possible causes, and develop a plan together. Strategies may include schedule adjustments, classroom changes, or referrals to outside resources.

- **Step 2: Written Behavior Plan.** If the behavior continues, a written behavior plan will be developed in partnership with the family. The plan will outline specific goals, strategies, and a timeline for improvement.
- **Step 3: Temporary Suspension.** If the behavior plan does not result in improvement and the child's behavior continues to pose a safety risk to themselves, other children, or staff, the child may be temporarily suspended (1 to 5 days) to allow time for the family and center to reassess the plan.
- **Step 4: Disenrollment.** If all reasonable interventions have been exhausted and the behavior continues to pose a persistent safety risk, the center may disenroll the child. Parents will receive 5 business days of written notice with the reasons for the decision.

In cases where a child's behavior poses an immediate danger to themselves or others (such as severe physical aggression causing injury), the center may temporarily remove the child from the classroom and require immediate parent pickup. The behavior escalation process will begin at the appropriate step based on the severity of the incident.

Biting Policy

Benevolent House Academy recognizes that biting is a common, developmentally typical behavior in infants and toddlers. Young children may bite because they lack the language to express frustration, excitement, or sensory needs. Our response to biting is rooted in understanding the reason behind the behavior while keeping all children safe. The safety of every child is our first priority. While the center responds to the biting child with patience and developmentally appropriate guidance, it also takes prompt action to protect the other children in the classroom, including increased or one-on-one supervision of the biting child and, when necessary, removing that child from the group during high-risk periods until the behavior is under better support.

- **First incident:** The caregiver separates the children, comforts the child who was bitten, and provides first aid. The biting child is redirected using age-appropriate guidance. Both families are notified on the day of occurrence through an incident report. The caregiver documents the circumstances (time of day, activity, possible triggers) to identify patterns.
- **Second incident (or emerging pattern):** The Director reviews the documentation for patterns. The caregiver adjusts the classroom environment to reduce triggers (additional supervision during high-risk times, seating changes, sensory tools). The parent of the biting child is contacted for a conference (Step 1) to discuss observations and develop strategies together.
- **Third incident or continued pattern:** A written behavior plan (Step 2) is developed with the family. The plan may include shadow supervision, introduction of sensory alternatives, schedule modifications, or referral to Early Childhood Intervention (ECI) or a behavioral specialist for evaluation. The Director monitors the plan daily.
- **Persistent biting after the plan is in place:** If biting continues despite consistent implementation of the behavior plan and the safety of other children remains at risk, temporary suspension (Step 3) may be used to allow the family and center to reassess. Disenrollment (Step 4) is considered only after all reasonable interventions have been exhausted.

At every step, caregivers respond with empathy and without shaming. Biting is never treated as willful misbehavior in infants and toddlers. The goal is always to identify what the child is communicating and to teach alternative ways to express that need.

Physical Aggression Policy (Hitting, Kicking, Pushing)

Physical aggression such as hitting, kicking, pushing, or throwing objects at others is addressed with the same trauma-informed, progressive approach. The center's response considers the child's age, developmental stage, and the context of the behavior.

- **First incident:** The caregiver intervenes immediately to ensure safety, separates the children involved, and uses emotion coaching to help the child identify what they were feeling. Both families are notified through an incident report on the day of occurrence.
- **Second incident (or emerging pattern):** The Director reviews the documentation for patterns. The caregiver implements targeted strategies (proximity supervision, offering choices before frustration escalates, teaching replacement behaviors). A parent conference (Step 1) is scheduled.
- **Third incident or continued pattern:** A written behavior plan (Step 2) is developed with the family. The plan may include individualized support strategies, a modified schedule, a classroom change, visual cue cards for emotional regulation, or referral for outside evaluation or support services.
- **Persistent aggression after the plan is in place:** If the behavior continues to pose a safety risk despite consistent implementation of the plan, temporary suspension (Step 3) and, if necessary, disenrollment (Step 4) may follow.

If a single incident of physical aggression results in serious injury to another child or a staff member, the center may require immediate parent pickup and begin the escalation process at Step 3 or Step 4 based on the severity of the incident.

2. List the activities that are appropriate for each age group you plan to serve. Include a sample schedule for each age group.

Detailed age-specific activity schedules are provided in Appendix B. A summary master schedule for daytime hours is provided below. Each classroom adapts this schedule to be developmentally appropriate for the age group served. Activity plans are posted in each classroom and updated regularly.

Master Daily Schedule (Daytime Hours)

Time	Activity
6:00 - 8:30 AM	Arrival, warm greetings, free play, table activities
8:30 - 9:00 AM	Breakfast (CACFP)
9:00 - 9:45 AM	Known & Growing block: Circle Time, feelings check-in, letters, music
9:45 - 11:30 AM	Learning centers, small groups, story time, outdoor play (staggered by classroom)
11:30 AM - 12:00 PM	Lunch (CACFP)
12:00 - 12:30 PM	Toileting and diapering, wind-down
12:30 - 2:30 PM	Nap/rest time (quiet activities for non-sleepers after 30 min)
2:30 - 3:00 PM	Afternoon snack (CACFP)
3:00 - 5:00 PM	Art, music, STEM, learning centers, outdoor play (staggered by

	classroom)
5:00 - 6:00 PM	Optional educational screen time, up to 30 minutes (Explorers, Innovators, Scholars), quiet play, pickup

Evening and Overnight Care Schedule (When Offered)

Time	Activity
6:00 - 7:00 PM	Dinner (CACFP)
7:00 - 8:00 PM	Quiet play, reading, wind-down activities
8:00 - 8:30 PM	Bedtime routine (bath/wash, pajamas, teeth brushing)
8:30 PM - 6:00 AM	Sleep; awake caregiver(s) on duty at all times

Benevolent House Academy is licensed for 24-hour care but does not currently provide evening or overnight care. When it is offered, the schedule above and the following provisions apply. The center provides age-appropriate sleeping arrangements, including cots or mats and individual bedding. Parents provide any comfort items. Awake caregivers remain on duty throughout the night and maintain required ratios. A minimum of 2 awake caregivers are on duty during all overnight hours to ensure ratio compliance across age groups and adequate coverage for emergencies. Per Texas licensing, children may not remain in continuous 24-hour care indefinitely. A break in care is required each calendar day.

Curriculum

Every classroom at Benevolent House Academy, from infants through Pre-K, uses Known & Growing, the curriculum created by Benevolent House Academy and rooted in the center's mission. Known & Growing is a whole-child approach that places social-emotional learning and character development at the heart of each day. It guides the daily feelings check-ins, the monthly character traits, letter and early-literacy learning, and original books and activities written by the BHA team. Activity plans are posted in each classroom and updated regularly.

When school-age care is offered, the school-age program follows an enrichment-based approach that includes academic support, STEM projects, art, music, life skills, and physical activity.

The center's programs incorporate four practices that make BHA unique: (1) a character development framework with monthly traits (kindness, courage, patience, respect) tied to activities, stories, and recognition; (2) daily social-emotional check-ins using feelings boards, morning circles, and calm-down corners; (3) family connection practices that honor and celebrate diverse family structures; and (4) Friday portfolios, which children bring home each week so families can see what their child has been learning.

Screen Time

Benevolent House Academy limits screen time in accordance with Texas Administrative Code Section 746.2207. Screen time is not used for children under 2 years of age. For children 2 years and older, screen time is educational, related to planned learning activities, does not exceed one hour per day, and is never used during meals, snacks, or rest, or as a substitute for physical activity, outdoor play, or caregiver interaction. Screen time is always supervised by a

caregiver and is turned off when not in use. The Explorers, Innovators, and Scholars classrooms may include up to 30 minutes of optional educational screen time near the end of the day. Any child under 2 in the Explorers classroom does a quiet alternative activity, such as books or puzzles, during that time.

3. In what area will the children rest and what type of napping equipment will they use?

Children rest in their assigned classrooms. Each classroom has sufficient space for individual cots or mats to be placed with at least 2 feet of space between them during rest time. Infants (0-11 months) sleep in individual safety-approved cribs that meet CPSC standards with firm mattresses and fitted sheets only. No blankets, pillows, bumper pads, quilts, stuffed animals, toys, sleep positioners, loose sheets, attached pacifiers, pacifiers with clips, cords, or hooks, or any other soft objects or restrictive devices are allowed in the crib. Toddlers and preschool-age children (12 months through 5 years) rest on individual cots or rest mats with individual bedding (sheet and lightweight blanket). When school-age care is offered, school-age children have cots or mats available if needed. Rest time is scheduled daily from 12:30 to 2:30 PM. Children who do not fall asleep after 30 minutes are provided quiet activities such as books, puzzles, or coloring at their cot or at a table so as not to disturb sleeping children.

4. On the floor plan attachment, identify the rooms to be used for each age group and the number of caregivers needed when the room is at full capacity.

See the Room Assignments and Capacity table above in Section II, Question 1, and the attached floor plan with rooms labeled by age group. At full capacity, 5 caregivers plus the director are required, or 6 caregivers when the Explorers room has more than 9 children and any child is under 2.

SECTION IV: ACTIVITIES AWAY FROM THE OPERATION

1. If you plan to take field trips, how will you ensure that the appropriate minimum standards rules are maintained?

Benevolent House Academy does not currently offer field trips. Field trips will be part of the school-age summer program when it is offered. When a field trip is scheduled, the following procedures ensure compliance with minimum standards: written parental authorization is obtained for each field trip before departure, child-to-caregiver ratios are maintained at all times (with additional staff or parent volunteers as needed to meet ratios), a first aid kit is taken on all field trips, each caregiver carries a roster of children in their group with emergency contact information, a head count is conducted before departure, at each transition, and upon return, caregivers carry a charged cell phone for emergency communication, children wear identification (such as matching shirts or name badges) for easy identification, and all transportation complies with the center's transportation safety policies.

2. Water activities

Benevolent House Academy does not offer water activities. The center does not provide sprinkler play, water tables, wading pools, or swimming pools, and children are not taken off-site for any water activities. No swimming or wading pools are located at the operation.

3. If you plan to provide transportation, how will you ensure that the appropriate minimum standards rules are maintained?

Benevolent House Academy does not currently provide transportation. Before the center transports any child, including for field trips or an emergency relocation, the following requirements are in place. All transportation complies with Chapter 746, Subchapter R of the

Texas Minimum Standards. Vehicles used for transportation are properly maintained, insured, and inspected. Each child transported has written parental authorization on file. Each director and employee who transports a child younger than 9 years old completes 2 clock hours of transportation safety training before transporting children and annually after that (Section 746.1316). Children are secured in age-appropriate safety restraints in compliance with Texas law. A head count is conducted before departure and upon arrival at each destination. No child is ever left unattended in a vehicle. During loading and unloading, a caregiver visually checks the entire vehicle interior (including under seats and in the back) after all children have exited to ensure no child is left behind. This visual check is documented each time.

Transportation Emergencies

Whenever children are transported, the following procedures apply in a transportation emergency (vehicle breakdown, accident, or medical emergency during transport):

- The driver or accompanying caregiver calls 911 immediately if there is an injury or imminent danger.
- All children remain secured in the vehicle unless the vehicle is unsafe (fire, smoke, or structural damage), in which case children are moved to a safe location away from traffic.
- The driver contacts the Director immediately to report the situation.
- The Director arranges for a replacement vehicle or alternate transportation and notifies parents of all children being transported.
- A head count is conducted immediately and continuously until all children are accounted for and safely returned to the center or released to their parents.
- An incident report is completed for every transportation emergency.

SECTION V: SAFETY, SANITATION AND FIRE

1. How will you ensure that the operation, both indoors and outdoors, is maintained to protect the health and safety of children?

The center conducts a daily safety check of all indoor and outdoor areas before children arrive each morning. The safety check includes verifying that all exits are clear and accessible, electrical outlets are covered, cleaning supplies and hazardous materials are locked and out of children's reach, outdoor play equipment is in good repair with no broken parts or sharp edges, the outdoor area is free of debris, standing water, and animal waste, all gates and fences are secure, indoor floors are clean and free of tripping hazards, and all areas are adequately lit and ventilated. Any identified hazards are corrected immediately before children are allowed access to the area. The daily safety check is documented on a checklist maintained at the center.

2. What is your plan for identifying persons who are authorized to pick up a child?

Authorized pickup persons are identified at enrollment and documented in the child's file in Brightwheel. Only persons listed on the child's authorized pickup list are allowed to remove a child from the center. If a caregiver does not recognize the person picking up the child, the caregiver requests a valid government-issued photo ID and verifies the name against the authorized pickup list before releasing the child. If the person is not on the authorized list, the caregiver contacts the parent to obtain verbal or written authorization before releasing the child. No child is released to an unauthorized person under any circumstances. If a custody order

restricts pickup by a specific individual, a copy of the order is maintained in the child's file and all caregivers are informed.

3. In areas that are enclosed or have an obstructed view, how will caregivers observe children at all times?

The facility is designed with open classroom layouts to maximize visibility. For any areas with an obstructed view, such as restroom areas or corners, caregivers position themselves to maintain a line of sight to all children. When children are using the restroom, caregivers remain at the restroom door. During outdoor play, caregivers are stationed at different points in the play area to ensure complete coverage. Caregivers conduct frequent head counts throughout the day. The director conducts periodic walk-throughs to verify that supervision practices are being followed. Mirrors are installed in any areas where sightlines are obstructed, if needed.

4. How will you ensure that the building, grounds, equipment, and supplies are maintained in a clean and sanitary manner?

The center follows a daily, weekly, and monthly cleaning and sanitation schedule. Daily tasks include: sanitizing all tables before and after meals and snacks, sanitizing diaper changing surfaces after each use, cleaning and sanitizing restrooms at least twice daily and as needed, sweeping and mopping floors, removing trash, and sanitizing toys that have been mouthed by infants and toddlers. Weekly tasks include: deep cleaning of all floors, laundering cot sheets and bedding, sanitizing all toys and materials, and cleaning windows and low surfaces. Monthly tasks include: deep cleaning of kitchen appliances, inspection and cleaning of outdoor equipment, and sanitizing storage areas. All cleaning products used are non-toxic and stored in a locked cabinet out of children's reach. The cleaning schedule is posted and documented.

5. How will you ensure that you and your caregivers wash their hands as specified in the minimum standard rules?

Handwashing procedures are posted at every sink in the center with visual step-by-step instructions. Children and staff wash hands with soap and running water: upon arrival at the center, before and after eating meals or snacks, before and after preparing or serving food, after toileting or assisting a child with toileting, after diapering, after wiping a child's nose or handling bodily fluids, after outdoor play, after handling animals or pets, and before and after administering medication. Caregivers assist younger children with proper handwashing technique. The director monitors handwashing compliance through observation during daily operations. Handwashing is reinforced during orientation and ongoing training.

6. How will you ensure that you and your caregivers follow diapering procedures as specified in the minimum standard rules?

Diaper changing stations are located in the Seedlings and Discoverers classrooms. Each station is equipped with a commercial diaper changing station with a safety strap and is located near a handwashing sink. Diapering procedures are posted at the changing station and include the following steps: prepare supplies before placing the child on the changing table, place the child on the changing surface and fasten the safety strap (never leave a child unattended on the changing table), remove the soiled diaper and place it in a hands-free covered receptacle, clean the child from front to back using disposable wipes, apply any creams or ointments as directed by the parent, put on a clean diaper, dress the child, wash the child's hands, place the child in a safe area, clean and sanitize the changing surface, and wash caregiver's hands thoroughly with soap and water. Diaper changing surfaces are sanitized after each use. Soiled diapers are disposed of in a lined, covered, hands-free receptacle that is emptied and cleaned daily.

Diapering procedures are covered during orientation and observed by the director to ensure compliance.

7. What is your plan to ensure the safety of children in case of fire, lockdown, or other emergency? Identify the designated relocation areas in and outside of the operation.

Benevolent House Academy maintains a comprehensive emergency preparedness plan addressing fire, severe weather, lockdown, and other emergencies. The plan is reviewed with all staff during orientation and at least annually.

Fire: Fire drills are conducted monthly and documented with the date, time, number of children participating, and length of the drill. Fire extinguishers are inspected annually and mounted in accessible locations. Smoke detectors are installed and maintained throughout the facility. The facility has clearly marked exits and emergency lighting. Evacuation routes are posted in every room.

Severe Weather: Severe weather (tornado/storm) drills are conducted 4 times a year (quarterly). The designated indoor shelter areas are the interior hallway and interior rooms away from exterior windows. A battery-operated weather radio is maintained at the center.

Lockdown: In the event of a threat requiring lockdown, all exterior doors are secured, children are moved away from windows and doors, a head count is verified, 911 is contacted, and staff remain in lockdown until cleared by law enforcement. Lockdown drills are conducted 4 times a year (quarterly). Drills follow Section 746.5205.

Medical Emergencies: Staff trained in first aid and CPR administer immediate care. 911 is called for life-threatening situations. Parents are notified immediately. An incident report is completed for all injuries and medical emergencies.

Designated Relocation Sites

If the facility must be evacuated and cannot be reoccupied, children will be transported to the nearest available designated relocation site. Whenever the emergency allows, the first place children and staff will relocate to is the Benevolent House offices located next door. Benevolent House Academy maintains the following designated relocation sites, listed in order of preference:

- Benevolent House, 504 SH-342, Red Oak, TX 75154 (primary relocation site, located next door)
- Red Oak Fire Department, 111 Live Oak Street, Red Oak, TX 75154 (offsite relocation site, day or night)

The specific relocation site used will depend on the nature, location, and timing of the emergency. The Director or designee will determine the appropriate site based on the circumstances. Parents are notified immediately of the relocation through Brightwheel and phone calls with the specific relocation address. The emergency bag, with each child's emergency contact information, emergency medical authorizations, and the day's attendance, goes with the group.

SECTION VI: PHYSICAL HEALTH AND WELL-BEING

1. What is your plan when a child gets ill or injured while at the operation?

When a child becomes ill, the caregiver notifies the director and the child is separated from the group in a supervised area until the parent can pick up. Parents are notified immediately through Brightwheel and by phone. The center follows the Communicable Disease Chart for Schools and Child-Care Centers published by the Texas Department of State Health Services for exclusion and readmission criteria. When a child is injured, the caregiver provides appropriate first aid. For serious injuries, 911 is called immediately. Parents are notified on the day of occurrence regardless of the severity of the injury. A written incident report is completed for every illness and injury, signed by the caregiver and the parent, and maintained in the child's file.

If a child or employee at the center contracts a communicable disease deemed notifiable by the Texas Department of State Health Services, all parents will be notified in writing within 48 hours. If there is an outbreak of lice or other infestation in a group, all parents in that group will be notified within 48 hours.

Health Checks

Caregivers conduct a visual health check of each child upon arrival each day. The health check includes observing the child for signs or symptoms of illness or injury, changes in behavior, and any visible marks or bruises. If a caregiver observes anything of concern, the parent will be asked for an explanation and the observation will be documented. If a child arrives showing signs of illness that meet the exclusion criteria, the parent will be asked to take the child home.

2. How will you ensure that medication is given properly?

Medication is administered only with written parental authorization and only as directed on the label and by a physician's written instructions, when applicable. The parent must complete a medication authorization form that includes the child's name, name of medication, dosage, time and method of administration, and any special instructions. All medications are stored in the original labeled container with the child's name, out of reach of children. Medications requiring refrigeration are stored in a small dedicated refrigerator in the office, separate from food items. A medication administration log is maintained that records the child's name, medication name, dosage given, time administered, and the name of the caregiver who administered it. The caregiver verifies the child's identity, medication name, dosage, time, and route before each administration. Medications are returned to the parent when no longer needed. Benevolent House Academy does not administer over-the-counter fever reducers or cough and cold medications; a child with a fever or symptoms of contagious illness is sent home rather than medicated to remain in care. Any medication the center does administer is given only at or below the dosing and age instructions on the label or the provider's written order. In accordance with TAC 746.3803(c), a parent may not authorize the center to administer medication in excess of the label instructions or the directions of the child's health-care professional; medication requested outside the label instructions, including by product age restriction, requires a written order from the child's health-care professional. Expired medications are removed from storage immediately and returned to the parent; if the parent cannot be reached, expired medications are disposed of in accordance with safe disposal practices.

Medication Safety Plan

If a child requires ongoing or emergency medication (such as an epinephrine auto-injector, inhaler, or seizure medication), the parent and the Director will develop a written medication

safety plan that includes the condition, triggers, medication details, administration instructions, and emergency response steps. The plan is kept in the child's file and a copy is posted in the child's classroom (accessible to staff, not visible to other families).

Unable to Reach Parent Regarding Medication

If a question or concern arises regarding a child's medication and the center is unable to reach the parent after three (3) contact attempts (phone call to parent, then to each emergency contact on file), the center will contact Poison Control at 1-800-222-1222 for guidance. In a medical emergency, 911 will be called immediately regardless of whether the parent has been reached. Parent authorization is not required to administer medication in a medical emergency to prevent the death or serious bodily injury of a child, per TAC 746.3803(d).

Epinephrine Auto-Injectors

Benevolent House Academy does not maintain an unassigned epinephrine auto-injector at this time. If a child has a known risk of anaphylaxis, the parent must provide a current, unexpired, prescribed epinephrine auto-injector with a completed medication authorization form and a food allergy emergency plan. The auto-injector will be stored in the child's classroom in a location accessible to staff and out of reach of children.

3. How will you ensure that the nutritional needs of the children are met on a daily basis? What meals will you serve? Provide a sample menu for a week on an attachment.

Benevolent House Academy participates in the Child and Adult Care Food Program (CACFP) to provide nutritious meals and snacks. Breakfast, lunch, and afternoon snack are served daily; dinner will be added when evening care is offered. Menus are planned in accordance with USDA nutritional guidelines and the CACFP meal pattern requirements. Benevolent House Academy is an egg and nut free facility, and menu items are checked against this policy before they are served. Weekly menus are posted in the kitchen and near the parent sign-in area for parent review. Food allergies and dietary restrictions are documented at enrollment, posted in the kitchen (first name only), and communicated to all caregivers. Caregivers verify each child's allergy information before serving meals. The four-week rotating menu is provided in Appendix A.

Outside Food Policy

As a general practice, outside food is not permitted at Benevolent House Academy. The center provides all meals and snacks, and the menu is designed to meet the nutritional needs of all children in care. If a child has a documented sensory need, religious dietary requirement, or health-based or medical dietary need that cannot be accommodated by the center's menu, the parent may request to provide the child's meals and snacks from home. In accordance with TAC 746.3309(a), the enrollment agreement or an addendum signed by the parent must include a statement that: (1) the parent is choosing to provide the child's meals and snacks from home; and (2) the parent understands the child-care center is not responsible for its nutritional value or for meeting the child's daily food needs. All parent-provided food must be labeled with the child's first and last name and date, and stored properly, and must be egg and nut free. If the parent provides a meal but not a snack, the center will provide the snack. Parent-provided snacks may not be shared with other children unless the parent is providing baked goods for a classroom

celebration and the items comply with the center's food safety and allergy policies, including the egg and nut free policy.

Infant Feeding

Infants are fed according to their individualized feeding plan provided by the parent. Infant feeding instructions are obtained from each parent in writing, signed and dated, and are reviewed and updated with the parent every 30 days until the infant is able to eat table food (Section 746.2421). Benevolent House Academy provides Similac 360 Total Care formula for infants through 12 months of age. Breast milk, specialty formula, and formula after the first birthday are provided by the parent. Iron-fortified infant cereal and age-appropriate pureed or soft foods are introduced based on the parent's written instructions and the child's developmental readiness. Infants are fed on demand and are never forced to eat.

8. Will the parents be required to supply any food?

No, parents are not required to supply food. The center provides all meals and snacks through the CACFP. However, parents may choose to provide food for their child if the child has a documented sensory need, religious dietary requirement, or health-based or medical dietary need that cannot be accommodated by the center's menu, subject to the outside food policy described above.

ADDITIONAL OPERATIONAL POLICIES

Animals

Benevolent House Academy does not keep animals or pets at the center. No animals are permitted on the premises during operating hours except for a special educational activity (such as a classroom visit from a local nature organization), in which case parents will be notified in advance. Children will only interact with animals under direct adult supervision, and any child with a known allergy to animals will be accommodated. All children wash their hands after any contact with animals.

Sunscreen and Insect Repellent

Benevolent House Academy does not provide sunscreen or insect repellent. If a parent would like the center to apply sunscreen or insect repellent to their child, the parent must provide the product labeled with the child's first and last name and complete a written authorization form specifying the product and when it should be applied. Only commercial, store-bought, EPA-registered products will be applied. The center will not apply homemade or unlabeled products. The authorization form specifies the type of product, the frequency of application, and any known sensitivities. Parents are encouraged to apply sunscreen before drop-off on days when outdoor play is expected. Staff will reapply during the day if authorization and a labeled product are on file.

Physical Activity and Outdoor Play

Benevolent House Academy promotes daily physical activity for all children as an essential part of healthy development. The benefits of physical activity include supporting cardiovascular

health, strengthening muscles and bones, improving coordination and balance, building confidence, enhancing social skills through cooperative play, and supporting cognitive development and self-regulation.

Children participate in both structured (caregiver-led) and unstructured (child-initiated) physical activities each day. Outdoor play is scheduled at least twice daily for all age groups (staggered by classroom). Physical activity takes place in the following settings: the outdoor play area (primary setting for gross motor activities, riding toys, climbing, running, and group games), individual classrooms (music and movement, yoga, dance, and indoor gross motor activities), and the indoor common area (obstacle courses and large-group movement activities during inclement weather).

Children should wear clothing and closed-toe shoes that allow them to run, climb, and move freely during outdoor and indoor physical activities. Children go outside daily unless weather conditions pose a significant health risk. The center uses the following criteria to determine when outdoor play is limited or moved indoors: temperatures at or above 100 degrees F (heat index), temperatures at or below 32 degrees F (wind chill), active thunderstorms or lightning, tornado warnings, heavy rain, ice, or other hazardous conditions as determined by the Director. On days when extreme weather limits outdoor play, indoor physical activity is provided to ensure children still have opportunities for active movement. Indoor alternatives include music and movement sessions, dance, yoga, obstacle courses, and other structured gross motor activities.

Immunization Requirements

Each child enrolled at Benevolent House Academy must meet the immunization requirements specified by the Texas Department of State Health Services (DSHS) for their age. Current immunization records must be provided at enrollment and kept up to date throughout the child's enrollment. Exemptions are available for medical reasons (signed by a physician) or for reasons of conscience, including religious beliefs (using the official DSHS affidavit form, which must be notarized). Children on provisional enrollment must complete required immunizations within the timelines established by DSHS rules. Tuberculosis (TB) screening or testing will be required only if mandated for our area by the regional Texas Department of State Health Services or the local health authority. If TB screening or testing is required, families will be notified.

Hearing and Vision Screening

Texas law requires hearing and vision screening for children ages 4 and older. Parents are responsible for ensuring their child receives the required screenings and providing documentation to the center.

Vaccine-Preventable Diseases

Benevolent House Academy maintains a policy on vaccine-preventable diseases as required by TAC 746.3611. The center encourages all employees to stay current on recommended immunizations to protect the health of children in care. Information about vaccine-preventable diseases and the center's employee immunization practices is available from the Director upon request.

Inclusive Services for Children with Special Care Needs

Benevolent House Academy is committed to providing inclusive care for all children, including children with disabilities, developmental delays, or other special care needs, in compliance with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA). The center will make reasonable accommodations to support each child's participation. If a child receives Early Childhood Intervention (ECI) services or special education services, qualified service providers are welcome to deliver those services at the center with parental request and approval. Caregivers integrate children with and without special care needs into all activities and adapt equipment and procedures as necessary to ensure that children with special needs are cared for in a natural environment.

Parent Rights

Parents may visit the center at any time during hours of operation to observe their child, the program activities, the building, the premises, and the equipment without having to secure prior approval. Parents have the right to breastfeed their child or provide breast milk for their child while in care. Benevolent House Academy provides a comfortable, private area with an adult-sized seat within the center for mothers who wish to breastfeed. Parents have the right to review their child's records, the center's most recent licensing inspection report, and the center's operational policies at any time during hours of operation. Parents also have the right, upon request, to review the center's staff training records and its in-house training curriculum, if any. Parents may access the Texas Minimum Standards for Child-Care Centers (Chapter 746) online at www.hhs.texas.gov/childcare, contact the Texas Abuse and Neglect Hotline at 1-800-252-5400, or visit the HHSC website at www.hhs.texas.gov. Benevolent House Academy will never retaliate against any parent for exercising any of their rights under Texas law.

Parent Involvement and Participation

Benevolent House Academy welcomes and encourages parent involvement. Parents may volunteer in their child's classroom, attend parent events and celebrations, communicate regularly with their child's caregiver and the Director, provide feedback on center policies and activities, and join field trips as a parent volunteer when field trips are offered (subject to background check requirements). All regular volunteers must complete a background check.

Questions, Concerns, and Grievances

Parents are welcome to review and discuss any of the center's policies and procedures with the Director at any time. If a parent has questions, concerns, or feedback about their child's care, classroom activities, or center policies, they are encouraged to speak with the Director. If the concern is not resolved to the parent's satisfaction, the parent may contact the Executive Director, Tanya Orr, by phone at (469) 807-1221 or by email at info@benevolenthouseacademy.org. If the parent believes the concern involves a violation of licensing standards or child safety, the parent may also contact HHSC Child Care Regulation at 1-800-582-6036 or the DFPS Abuse and Neglect Hotline at 1-800-252-5400. Parents are never required to go through the center first before contacting a regulatory agency.

Child Abuse and Neglect Prevention and Reporting

Every employee at Benevolent House Academy is a mandatory reporter under Texas law. All employees complete annual training on recognizing the signs and symptoms of child abuse and neglect, understanding risk factors, and fulfilling their legal obligation to report. The center educates employees and parents on warning signs that a child may be a victim of abuse or neglect and factors that may place a child at increased risk. Employees are trained in prevention techniques, including maintaining appropriate boundaries, proper supervision practices, and creating a safe environment. Benevolent House Academy coordinates with community organizations, including DFPS, local law enforcement, and family support agencies, to support child safety. Parents may report suspected abuse or neglect directly to the Texas DFPS Abuse and Neglect Hotline at 1-800-252-5400 or online at www.txabusehotline.org at any time.

Liability Insurance Notice

As a newly established center, and as of the effective date of this plan, Benevolent House Academy does not carry liability insurance, as permitted under Texas Administrative Code Section 746.205. This is common for new child-care operations during their initial period of licensure, and the center is working toward obtaining coverage. Parents are provided with a separate written notice about this before their child is admitted into care. When insurance is obtained, the center will carry a minimum of \$300,000 per occurrence as required by TAC 746.203.

Gang-Free Zone Notice

Under the Texas Penal Code, any area within 1,000 feet of a child-care center is a gang-free zone. Criminal offenses related to organized criminal activity that occur in a gang-free zone are subject to harsher penalties under Texas law.

Late Pickup Policy

The center closes at 6:00 PM, and all children must be picked up by 6:00 PM. A fee of \$1 per minute applies for every minute after 6:00 PM (or after the posted closing time on early-closing days). If it is 6:30 PM and the center has not been able to reach the parent by phone, the center will begin calling the emergency contacts listed in the child's file. If the center is unable to reach the parent or any emergency contact by 7:00 PM, the center will contact local law enforcement and/or Child Protective Services. Chronic late pickup (defined as 5 or more instances in a rolling 12-month period) may result in disenrollment after a meeting with the family.

Weather Closures and Center Closures

Benevolent House Academy follows Red Oak ISD for weather closures and delayed openings. If Red Oak ISD closes due to weather, the center is closed. If Red Oak ISD delays its start, the center opens at the same time Red Oak ISD schools open that day. If weather, a power outage, or another emergency makes it unsafe to operate during the day, the center may close early and families are notified through Brightwheel and by phone call. Tuition is due regardless of

weather-related closures. If the center is closed for 5 or more consecutive business days, tuition credits will be evaluated on a case-by-case basis by the Executive Director.

INFANT CARE PROVISIONS

The Seedlings classroom provides specialized care for infants 6 weeks through 11 months. Infant feeding instructions are obtained from each parent in writing and are reviewed and updated with the parent every 30 days until the infant is able to eat table food. Each infant follows an individualized schedule for feeding, sleeping, and diapering. Infants are always placed on their backs to sleep in bare cribs. No blankets, pillows, bumper pads, quilts, stuffed animals, toys, sleep positioners, loose sheets, attached pacifiers, pacifiers with clips, cords, or hooks, or any other soft objects or restrictive devices are allowed in the crib, in compliance with safe sleep standards per Section 746.2409. Swaddling is not permitted. Tummy time is provided daily under direct supervision when infants are awake. Caregivers of children younger than 24 months (Seedlings, Discoverers, and Explorers) complete one hour of pre-service training and at least one hour of annual training on prevention of shaken baby syndrome and abusive head trauma, safe sleep and SIDS prevention, and early childhood brain development.

COMPLIANCE COMMITMENT

Benevolent House Academy is committed to full compliance with Chapter 746 of the Texas Administrative Code (Minimum Standards for Child-Care Centers), Chapter 42 of the Texas Human Resources Code, and all applicable rules and regulations governing licensed child care operations in Texas. The director is responsible for ensuring daily on-site compliance. The head of the governing body ensures the operation has adequate resources, personnel, and policies to maintain compliance. The center cooperates fully with all Child Care Regulation inspections, investigations, and technical assistance visits. All deficiencies identified during inspections are corrected promptly.

SIGNATURE

A separate signature page is provided and maintained on file.

APPENDIX A: FOUR-WEEK ROTATING MENU (CACFP)

Benevolent House Academy serves the four-week rotating menu below, which follows USDA Child and Adult Care Food Program (CACFP) meal patterns. The menu repeats continuously, and a calendar key posted with the menu shows which week is being served. Milk is served with breakfast and lunch: whole milk for children 12 to 23 months, and unflavored 1% or fat-free milk for children 2 and older. Water is offered throughout the day. Substitutions are made for children with documented food allergies or dietary restrictions. Menus are posted in the kitchen and near the parent sign-in area.

Week 1

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	PM Snack
Monday	Mini pancakes, peaches, milk	Beef ravioli, green beans, pears, milk	Vanilla wafers, applesauce, water
Tuesday	Buttered toast, pineapple, milk	Chicken nuggets, corn, pineapple, milk	String cheese, crackers, water
Wednesday	Sausage patty with toast, pears, milk	Mac and cheese, carrots, applesauce, milk	Goldfish crackers, mandarin oranges, water
Thursday	Yogurt, peaches, milk	Fish sticks, broccoli, pineapple, milk	Pretzels, fruit cocktail, water
Friday	French toast sticks, mandarin oranges, milk	Mini tacos, peas and carrots, peaches, milk	Graham crackers, applesauce, water

Week 2

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	PM Snack
Monday	Waffles, pears, milk	Spaghetti and meatballs, green beans, mandarin oranges, milk	Animal crackers, peaches, water
Tuesday	Nutri-Grain bar, pineapple, milk	Popcorn chicken, sweet potatoes, pears, milk	String cheese, crackers, water
Wednesday	Muffin, peaches, milk	Mini corn dogs, peas, applesauce, milk	Teddy grahams, mandarin oranges, water
Thursday	Blueberry pancakes on a stick, pears, milk	Chili with shredded cheese, mixed vegetables, fruit cocktail, milk	Vanilla wafers, peaches, water
Friday	Gogurt pouch, mandarin oranges, milk	Cheese quesadilla, corn, pineapple, milk	Graham crackers, applesauce, water

Week 3

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	PM Snack
Monday	Cheerios, peaches, milk	Lasagna, cauliflower, peaches, milk	Goldfish crackers, applesauce, water
Tuesday	English muffin with butter, banana, milk	Cheese pizza, California blend, pineapple, milk	String cheese, crackers, water
Wednesday	Hash brown patty, toast, pears, milk	Beefaroni, carrots, pineapple, milk	Pretzels, mandarin oranges, water
Thursday	French toast rounds, peaches, milk	Sausage kolaches, mashed potatoes, pears, milk	Animal crackers, fruit cocktail, water
Friday	Rice Krispies, mandarin oranges, milk	Mini beef ravioli, corn, peaches, milk	Graham crackers, applesauce, water

Week 4

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	PM Snack
Monday	Mini pancakes, pears, milk	Chicken patty with fried rice, green beans, applesauce, milk	Teddy grahams, peaches, water
Tuesday	Buttered biscuit, pineapple, milk	Chicken taquitos, corn, mandarin oranges, milk	Vanilla wafers, mandarin oranges, water
Wednesday	Sausage biscuit, peaches, milk	Mini cheeseburger sliders, peas, peaches, milk	String cheese, crackers, water
Thursday	Cinnamon raisin toast, pears, milk	Pizza rolls, sweet potatoes, fruit cocktail, milk	Pretzels, peaches, water
Friday	Cornflakes, mandarin oranges, milk	Chicken nuggets, mixed vegetables, pears, milk	Goldfish crackers, applesauce, water

Infant Meals: Infants are fed according to their individualized feeding plan provided by the parent. Benevolent House Academy provides Similac 360 Total Care formula for infants through 12 months of age; breast milk and specialty formula are provided by the parent. Iron-fortified infant cereal and age-appropriate pureed or soft foods are introduced based on the parent's written instructions and the child's developmental readiness. Infants are fed on demand and are never forced to eat.

Note: Benevolent House Academy is an egg and nut free facility. Menu items are checked against this policy and against each enrolled child's allergy documentation before they are served. Foods are cut to a safe size for each age group, including cutting hot dogs, corn dogs, and similar foods into small pieces for children under 4. No meals are served on closure days.

APPENDIX B: AGE-SPECIFIC ACTIVITY SCHEDULES

The following schedules are tailored to the developmental needs of each age group served at Benevolent House Academy and match the schedules posted in each classroom (Section 746.2206). All schedules include at least two daily outdoor opportunities (weather permitting), a balance of active and quiet, individual and group, and caregiver-directed and child-initiated activities, CACFP meals and snacks, and supervised rest. Outdoor times are staggered so that only one classroom uses the playground at a time, and drinking water is available throughout the day. Every classroom uses Known & Growing, the curriculum created by Benevolent House Academy.

Seedlings (Classroom 0): Infants, 6 Weeks to 11 Months

Infants follow individualized schedules based on each child's needs and parent instructions. The following represents a general rhythm:

Time	Activity	Developmental Focus
6:00 - 8:30 AM	Arrival, warm greetings, feeding on demand, diapering, tummy time	Secure attachment, responsive care
8:30 - 9:00 AM	Breakfast and bottles (solids per each infant's feeding plan)	Nutrition, self-feeding
9:00 - 9:45 AM	Known & Growing block: sensory play, music, board books, feelings check-in	Sensory and language development
9:45 - 10:15 AM	Tummy time, floor play, reaching and grasping	Gross and fine motor
10:15 - 10:45 AM	Outdoor stroller walk on the walking path, as tolerated	Fresh air, environmental awareness
10:45 - 11:30 AM	Bottles on demand, mirror play, soft-toy exploration	Self-awareness, nutrition
11:30 AM - 12:00 PM	Lunch and bottles (solids per feeding plan)	Nutrition, self-feeding
12:00 - 12:30 PM	Diapering, lullabies, wind-down	Self-regulation
12:30 - 2:30 PM	Nap and rest on demand (bare cribs, placed on back)	Physical rest
2:30 - 3:00 PM	Afternoon snack and bottles	Nutrition
3:00 - 3:30 PM	Outdoor stroller walk on the walking path, as tolerated	Fresh air, sensory
3:30 - 5:00 PM	Floor play, caregiver interaction, songs, reading	Language, attachment
5:00 - 6:00 PM	Feeding on demand, calm play, pickup	Responsive care

Note: Infants are fed on demand. Diapering occurs as needed (at least every two hours). All infants are placed on their backs to sleep in bare cribs and are never left to sleep in swings, bouncers, or car seats. For infants, outdoor time is offered as tolerated by each infant (Section 746.2206). Infant stroller walks use the walking path and are separate from the playground.

Discoverers (Classroom 1): Young Toddlers, 12 to 17 Months

Time	Activity	Developmental Focus
6:00 - 8:30 AM	Arrival, free play with soft toys, social-emotional greeting	Separation transition, social-emotional
8:30 - 9:00 AM	Breakfast	Self-feeding, nutrition
9:00 - 9:30 AM	Outdoor play on the playground (balls, ride-on toys)	Gross motor, fresh air
9:30 - 10:15 AM	Known & Growing block: Circle Time, music and movement, finger plays, feelings check-in	Language, gross motor, listening
10:15 - 11:00 AM	Learning centers: sensory bins, stacking and sorting, push-and-pull toys	Fine motor, cause and effect
11:00 - 11:30 AM	Story time, board books, puppet play	Language, early literacy
11:30 AM - 12:00 PM	Lunch	Self-feeding, social interaction
12:00 - 12:30 PM	Diapering, Quiet Reset Space, wind-down	Self-regulation
12:30 - 2:30 PM	Nap on individual cots	Physical rest
2:30 - 3:00 PM	Snack	Nutrition, self-help
3:00 - 3:30 PM	Outdoor play on the playground	Gross motor, social
3:30 - 4:30 PM	Art exploration (finger paint, large crayons), sensory table	Fine motor, creativity
4:30 - 5:15 PM	Free-choice centers, music	Choice, independence
5:15 - 6:00 PM	Quiet free play, books, pickup	Wind-down, choice

Explorers (Classroom 2): Older Toddlers, 18 to 35 Months

Time	Activity	Developmental Focus
6:00 - 8:30 AM	Arrival, free play, table toys, social-emotional greeting	Social skills, fine motor
8:30 - 9:00 AM	Breakfast	Self-help, nutrition
9:00 - 9:30 AM	Known & Growing block: Circle Time (songs, finger plays, feelings check-in); letter, name, and pre-writing woven in	Language, social, listening
9:30 - 10:00 AM	Outdoor play on the playground (ride-on toys, balls, chalk)	Gross motor, sensory
10:00 - 11:00 AM	Learning centers: playdough, blocks, pretend play, sensory	Cognitive, fine motor, imagination
11:00 - 11:30 AM	Story time, flannel board stories	Literacy, vocabulary
11:30 AM - 12:00 PM	Lunch	Self-feeding, manners
12:00 - 12:30 PM	Toileting and diapering, wind-down	Self-regulation
12:30 - 2:30 PM	Nap on individual cots	Physical rest

2:30 - 3:00 PM	Snack	Nutrition
3:00 - 3:30 PM	Themed art, music and dance	Creativity, expression
3:30 - 4:00 PM	Outdoor play on the playground	Gross motor, exploration
4:00 - 5:00 PM	Learning centers, free choice	Choice, fine motor
5:00 - 5:30 PM	Optional educational screen time (up to 30 minutes; children under 2 do a quiet alternative activity)	Wind-down, choice
5:30 - 6:00 PM	Quiet free play, books, pickup	Wind-down, choice

Innovators (Classroom 3): Preschool, 3 Years

Time	Activity	Developmental Focus
6:00 - 8:30 AM	Arrival, table activities (puzzles, books), greeting	Fine motor, literacy
8:30 - 9:00 AM	Breakfast	Self-help, social
9:00 - 9:30 AM	Known & Growing block: Circle Time (calendar, weather, feelings check-in, letter of the week); name and pre-writing woven in	Math, literacy, social-emotional
9:30 - 10:00 AM	Learning centers, round one: science, writing, art	STEM, literacy, creativity
10:00 - 10:30 AM	Outdoor play on the playground (climbing, group games)	Gross motor, cooperation
10:30 - 11:15 AM	Learning centers, round two: dramatic play, blocks, manipulatives	Social, cognitive
11:15 - 11:30 AM	Story time, read-aloud	Comprehension, vocabulary
11:30 AM - 12:00 PM	Lunch	Self-help, conversation
12:00 - 12:30 PM	Toileting, quiet transition	Self-regulation
12:30 - 2:30 PM	Nap and rest (quiet activities for non-sleepers after 30 minutes)	Rest, self-regulation
2:30 - 3:00 PM	Snack	Nutrition
3:00 - 3:30 PM	Themed art, music, or STEM activity	Creativity, cognitive
3:30 - 4:00 PM	Free-choice centers	Choice, social
4:00 - 4:30 PM	Outdoor play on the playground	Gross motor, social
4:30 - 5:15 PM	Music and movement, dramatic play	Active play, expression
5:15 - 5:45 PM	Optional educational screen time (up to 30 minutes)	Wind-down, choice
5:45 - 6:00 PM	Quiet free play, puzzles, pickup	Wind-down, choice

Scholars (Classroom 4): Pre-K, 4 to 5 Years

Time	Activity	Developmental Focus
6:00 - 8:30 AM	Arrival, journaling, table activities, greeting	Literacy, fine motor
8:30 - 9:00 AM	Breakfast	Self-help, social skills
9:00 - 9:45 AM	Known & Growing block: Circle Time (calendar, phonics, number of the day, feelings check-in, sharing); letter, name, and writing woven in	Math, literacy, social-emotional
9:45 - 10:30 AM	Small group and learning centers: writing, math, science, reading	School readiness, STEM, literacy
10:30 - 11:00 AM	Outdoor play on the playground (organized games, obstacle course)	Gross motor, teamwork
11:00 - 11:30 AM	Story time and read-aloud, language activities	Comprehension, vocabulary
11:30 AM - 12:00 PM	Lunch	Self-help, conversation, manners
12:00 - 12:30 PM	Toileting, quiet transition	Self-regulation
12:30 - 2:30 PM	Nap and rest (quiet activities for non-sleepers after 30 minutes)	Rest, self-regulation
2:30 - 3:00 PM	Snack	Nutrition
3:00 - 3:45 PM	Art, music, dramatic play, or STEM challenge	Creativity, problem-solving
3:45 - 4:30 PM	Free-choice learning centers	Choice, social
4:30 - 5:00 PM	Outdoor play on the playground	Gross motor, free choice
5:00 - 5:30 PM	Optional educational screen time (up to 30 minutes)	Social skills, wind-down
5:30 - 6:00 PM	Board games, books, free play, pickup	Social skills, wind-down

Achievers (Classroom 5): School-Age Summer Program (When Offered)

Time	Activity	Developmental Focus
6:00 - 8:30 AM	Arrival, free play, books, table games	Social skills, choice
8:30 - 9:00 AM	Breakfast	Nutrition
9:00 - 10:00 AM	Arts and crafts, free choice (building, blocks, dramatic play)	Creativity, problem-solving
10:00 - 11:00 AM	Free play and games	Social skills, cooperation
11:00 - 11:30 AM	Outdoor play on the playground	Gross motor, teamwork
11:30 AM - 12:00 PM	Lunch	Nutrition, social skills
12:00 - 12:30 PM	Clean-up, settle in for quiet time	Responsibility
12:30 - 2:30 PM	Quiet time: reading, drawing, puzzles, board games; optional educational movie or show (up to 1 hour)	Self-regulation, literacy

2:30 - 3:00 PM	Snack	Nutrition
3:00 - 4:00 PM	Crafts, creative projects, or free play	Creativity
4:00 - 5:00 PM	Free choice: building, dramatic play, arts and crafts, board games, reading	Choice, social
5:00 - 5:30 PM	Outdoor play on the playground	Gross motor, teamwork
5:30 - 6:00 PM	Free play, games, pickup	Social, wind-down

Achievers (Classroom 5): Full-Day School-Age Program (When Offered)

The following full-day schedule is for school-age children (K-5th grade) who attend Benevolent House Academy full-time rather than a traditional school, when this program is offered. During quiet and rest time (12:30 to 2:30), these children do quiet activities while the younger classrooms nap.

Time	Activity	Developmental Focus
6:00 - 8:00 AM	Arrival, quiet reading, morning journaling	Routine, literacy
8:00 - 8:30 AM	Morning meeting, goal-setting	Social-emotional, planning
8:30 - 9:00 AM	Breakfast	Nutrition, social
9:00 - 10:15 AM	Academic support (reading, writing, math)	Literacy, numeracy
10:15 - 11:00 AM	Enrichment centers: STEM and building, art studio, dramatic play, reading nook	Critical thinking, creativity
11:00 - 11:30 AM	Outdoor play on the playground	Gross motor, self-regulation
11:30 AM - 12:00 PM	Lunch	Nutrition, social skills
12:00 - 12:30 PM	Quiet transition, clean-up	Responsibility
12:30 - 2:30 PM	Quiet activities: independent reading, projects, journaling, board games; optional educational screen time (up to 45 minutes)	Self-regulation, literacy
2:30 - 3:00 PM	Snack	Nutrition
3:00 - 4:00 PM	Project-based learning (science, writing, community)	Problem-solving, collaboration
4:00 - 5:00 PM	Combined group: homework help, building, dramatic play, arts and crafts, reading	Academic support, choice
5:00 - 5:30 PM	Outdoor play on the playground	Gross motor, teamwork
5:30 - 6:00 PM	Free choice, pickup	Choice, social

Full-time scholars' families direct their child's educational goals. BHA provides a structured, supportive environment with academic support time, enrichment activities, and educational materials. BHA does not serve as an accredited school and does not issue grades or academic transcripts. During school holidays, teacher workdays, and summer, all school-age children follow this same full-day schedule.

APPENDIX C: NEW EMPLOYEE ORIENTATION CURRICULUM

Benevolent House Academy's orientation curriculum is grounded in trauma-informed care and social-emotional development principles. Every new employee completes this orientation within 7 days of hire and before having unsupervised access to a child in care. Nonexempt caregivers also complete 8 clock hours of pre-service training before being counted in ratio.

Module 1: Welcome and Center Overview (1 hour)

Mission, vision, and values of Benevolent House Academy. Organizational structure: governing body, director, caregivers. Tour of the facility including all classrooms, outdoor areas, emergency exits, fire extinguishers, first aid kits, and hazardous materials storage. Review of employee handbook, job description, and expectations. Introduction to Brightwheel (parent communication, attendance, daily reports). Dress code (BHA-branded shirts required during all operating hours), attendance, and professional conduct policies.

Module 2: Minimum Standards Overview (1 hour)

Introduction to Chapter 746 (Minimum Standards for Child-Care Centers). Role of Child Care Regulation (CCR) and the licensing process. Understanding what an inspection looks like and how to prepare. Child-to-caregiver ratio requirements by age group. Required postings (license, inspection report, emergency numbers, menus, activity plans). Record-keeping requirements for children and personnel files.

Module 3: Trauma-Informed Care Foundations (1.5 hours)

Understanding Adverse Childhood Experiences (ACEs) and their impact on brain development and behavior. Recognizing trauma responses in children: fight (aggression, defiance), flight (withdrawal, avoidance, running), freeze (shutting down, dissociation), and fawn (people-pleasing, hypervigilance). The difference between behavior that is willful and behavior that is a stress response. Core principles of trauma-informed care: safety, trustworthiness, choice, collaboration, and empowerment. Creating emotionally safe classroom environments. Using predictable routines and transitions to build security. Self-care for caregivers: recognizing secondary traumatic stress and compassion fatigue.

Module 4: Social-Emotional Development and Positive Guidance (1.5 hours)

Understanding social-emotional milestones by age group. Emotion coaching: helping children identify, name, and regulate their feelings. The role of co-regulation (caregiver staying calm to help a child regulate). Positive guidance techniques: encouragement, redirection, choices, natural consequences, brief separation. Relationship-based discipline: connecting before correcting. Prohibited discipline methods (detailed review with examples). Strategies for specific challenging behaviors: biting, hitting, tantrums, separation anxiety, food refusal. Building secure attachment through responsive caregiving. Documenting behavior concerns and communicating with families.

Module 5: Child Abuse and Neglect Prevention, Recognition, and Reporting (1 hour)

Texas law requirements for mandatory reporters. Definition of abuse, neglect, and exploitation under Texas Family Code Chapter 261. Factors indicating a child is at risk of abuse or neglect. Physical and behavioral warning signs indicating a child may be a victim of abuse or neglect. How to document and report suspected abuse or neglect to DFPS (1-800-252-5400 and online reporting). What happens after a report is filed. Protection from retaliation for reporting in good faith. Community organizations with training available to staff, children, and parents. Internal procedures when an allegation involves a center employee.

Module 6: Health, Safety, and Emergency Procedures (1 hour)

Daily safety check procedures (indoor and outdoor). Illness identification and exclusion criteria (Communicable Disease Chart). Injury response and incident report procedures. Medication administration procedures. Location and use of fire extinguishers and first aid equipment. Emergency preparedness plan review: fire, severe weather, lockdown, medical, and relocation to designated sites. Evacuation routes (review posted maps in each room). Administering medication in compliance with 26 TAC Section 746.3803. Preventing and responding to food allergies and allergic reactions. Building safety and hazard identification (electrical, water, vehicular, toxic materials). Handling, storing, and disposing of hazardous materials per 26 TAC Section 746.3425. Shaken baby syndrome prevention, SIDS prevention, and safe sleep practices (caregivers of children younger than 24 months).

Module 7: Daily Operations and Age-Specific Practices (0.5 hours)

Daily schedule review for assigned classroom. Handwashing procedures (posted at every sink). Diapering procedures (Seedlings, Discoverers, and Explorers staff). Feeding and mealtime procedures (including infant feeding plans). Nap/rest time procedures and supervision. Outdoor play supervision and head count procedures. Sign-in/sign-out and authorized pickup verification. Brightwheel daily reporting requirements (activities, meals, naps, incidents).

Module 8: Transportation Safety Overview (0.5 hours)

The center does not currently provide transportation; this module is an overview. Before transporting a child younger than 9 years old, each director and employee who transports children completes 2 clock hours of transportation safety training, and repeats it annually (Section 746.1316). Overview topics: vehicle safety inspection procedures, proper use of age-appropriate safety restraints, head count procedures before departure and upon arrival, visual vehicle check after unloading (under seats, back of vehicle), documentation requirements, never leaving a child unattended in a vehicle, and transportation emergency procedures.

Orientation Completion

Upon completion of all modules, the employee signs an Orientation Completion Form acknowledging they have received and understand the training. The signed form is placed in the employee's personnel file. Nonexempt caregivers complete the remaining 16 clock hours of the

24-hour pre-service requirement within 90 days of employment, and pediatric first aid and pediatric CPR within 90 days of employment. Annual training (24 clock hours for caregivers, 30 for directors) is separate and is completed within each 12-month period from the date of hire.

APPENDIX D: EQUIPMENT AND MATERIALS CHECKLIST BY ROOM

The following checklist identifies the equipment and materials provided in each classroom and the outdoor play area. Equipment is age-appropriate, in good repair, and meets applicable safety standards. Equipment is inspected regularly and replaced as needed.

Seedlings (Classroom 0, 6 Weeks to 11 Months) - Indoor

Item	Quantity	Safety Standard
Safety-approved cribs with firm mattresses	4	CPSC compliant
Fitted crib sheets	8 (2 per crib)	
Diaper changing station with safety strap	1	Commercial grade
Infant swings	2	CPSC compliant; awake and supervised only, never for sleep
Bouncer/rocker seats	2	CPSC compliant; awake and supervised only, never for sleep
Tummy time mats/play mats	4	Non-toxic
Soft blocks, stacking rings, rattles	Assorted	No small parts
Teething toys	Assorted	BPA-free
Unbreakable wall mirrors	2	Shatterproof
Board books	15+	
Bottles/feeding supplies storage	1 unit	Labeled by child
Hands-free diaper receptacle with lid	1	Lined, covered

Discoverers, Explorers, Innovators, and Scholars (Classrooms 1-4) - Indoor

Item	Qty Per Room	Notes
Child-sized tables	2-4	Age-appropriate height
Child-sized chairs	One per child	Age-appropriate height
Individual cots or rest mats	One per child (5 to 17 per room)	Labeled by child
Cot sheets and blankets	2 sets per child	Laundered weekly
Building blocks (age-appropriate size)	1 set	Large blocks (young) to small blocks (older)
Puzzles (age-appropriate piece count)	6-10	3-piece to 24-piece
Art supplies (crayons, markers, paint, glue, scissors)	Assorted	Non-toxic, safety scissors
Playdough/modeling clay	1 set	Non-toxic
Dramatic play items (kitchen, dolls, dress-up)	1 center	Multicultural dolls

Books (age-appropriate)	20+	Rotated regularly
Sensory table/bins	1	Sand, rice, and other dry materials
Musical instruments	Assorted	Rhythm sticks, shakers, drums
Science/nature materials (magnifying glasses, plants)	1 center	Innovators and Scholars
Math manipulatives (counters, patterns, shapes)	1 set	Innovators and Scholars
Writing center (journals, pencils, letter cards)	1 center	Scholars
Educational tablet/computer	1	Explorers, Innovators, and Scholars; supervised, up to 30 minutes a day

Achievers (Classroom 5, School-Age, When Offered) - Indoor

Item	Quantity	Notes
Tables and chairs (school-age size)	3 tables, 10 chairs	
Homework supplies (pencils, paper, rulers, etc.)	Assorted	Restocked monthly
Age-appropriate books and magazines	30+	Variety of genres/levels
Board games and card games	10+	Rotated seasonally
Arts and crafts supplies	Assorted	
Science kits and STEM materials	3-5	Rotated
Building sets (Lego, K'Nex, etc.)	2-3 sets	
Educational tablet/computer	1-2	Supervised, educational use
Cots or rest mats (as needed)	14	Available for rest

Outdoor Play Area (All Ages, Staggered Schedule)

Item	Quantity	Notes
Age-appropriate climbing structure with slide	1	CPSC/ASTM compliant
Ride-on toys	2-4	Foot-powered
Balls (various sizes)	10+	Age-appropriate sizes
Outdoor art supplies (chalk, easel)	Assorted	Washable, non-toxic
Sports equipment (jump ropes, hula hoops, cones)	Assorted	School-age focused
Picnic tables (child and standard size)	3-4	Age-appropriate heights
Outdoor storage bin for equipment	1	Weatherproof

All outdoor equipment is installed on appropriate safety surfacing and is inspected daily before children access the outdoor area. Equipment is anchored securely and maintained in good repair. Broken or unsafe equipment is removed immediately from the play area.